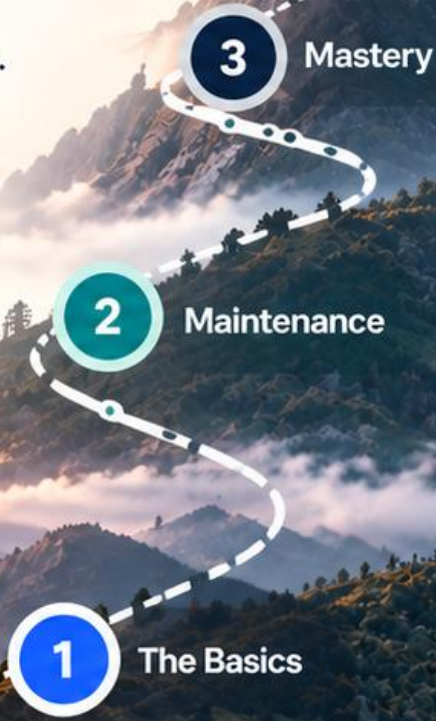


Well-being is a journey

Maintaining a fully charged well-being battery requires a combination of habits which build on and reinforce one another. It is okay to start small—in fact, it is exactly how you should start. Well-being is a lifelong journey, and most of us are on Step 1!



3

Step 3

Mastery

At this stage, your routines help you consistently perform at your best, even when facing life's challenges. You proactively manage your energy and adjust automatically. You clearly understand what works for you, including how past joyful and difficult experiences have shaped you. You also bring a high level of awareness to how this influences your mindset and behaviors, and you become a role model for others.



2

Step 2

Maintenance

You are better able to stay towards the top of your well-being, even when life's events try to throw you off track. By consciously integrating well-being practices such as recovery and emotional flexibility, you maintain a stable sense of well-being.



1

Step 1

The Basics

Starting out small means setting a foundation of small but regular and purposeful actions (e.g., getting more sleep, moving for 20 minutes every day, or connecting with others). By increasing your awareness and ability to apply well-being practices, you are better able to cope with stress.



Did you know?

For some people, starting small may feel like a lack of ambition. They would rather set a big goal and go for it.

However, there is tremendous power in starting small. For example, at the micro level you can find brief moments during the day to charge your well-being battery.

At the macro level, you can move towards large goals in small increments and then celebrate each success. These small successes cause your body to release dopamine, which sends a chemical message to feel good. In turn, this helps you stay motivated to keep going.



BIG GOAL

Your long-term aspiration.



Macro level

Move towards large goals in small increments and celebrate each success.



Micro level

Find brief moments during the day to charge your well-being battery.



Short walk



Deep breath



A glass of water



Mindful pause

Why it works?



1. Small Success

You take small steps and achieve them.



2. Dopamine Release

Your body releases dopamine, a chemical that makes you feel good.



3. Higher Motivation

You feel more motivated to keep going.

The power of feedback

To track your well-being, a great way is to ask for feedback. There are two ways to obtain feedback: analog (in person) and high-tech (technology).

1 Analog (in person) Feedback

Pay attention to intentional or unintentional feedback you receive from the people around you. If they consistently inquire about your well-being, especially during or after tense meetings, they may sense that something is "off." Even better, solicit open feedback from any of the following people:

-  Your colleagues
-  Your team members
-  A coach or mentor
-  Your family members
-  Your close friends and/or partner



2 Get High-Tech (technology) Feedback

Wearable technologies can track heart rate, blood oxygen levels, sleeping patterns, movement patterns, stress levels, etc. Some can track your heart rate variability (HRV), the variation in the time interval between heartbeats, which can be influenced by stress, lack of sleep, fitness levels, nutrition, age, and genetics. Tracking your HRV over time shows how well you are recovering. Low HRV is a predictor of reduced resilience, burnout, and cardiovascular disease.



Try it now: Creating your recovery plan

1

It's time to create your recovery plan

Identify the activities and routines that give you energy and those that drain you. While sleep, exercise, and nutrition are common to everyone, other elements are highly personal.

2

Understand what energizes vs. drains you

People are different—introverts may find certain social activities draining, while extroverts may find them energizing. Take note of how each activity affects your energy levels.

3

Include social activities

For activities with others (e.g., meeting specific friends, group activities, or lunch with colleagues), think of the specific people who energize you and include their names or initials in your recovery

Examples of recovery activities



Group meetings



1:1 meetings



Highly focused individual work



Zoom meetings



Commuting (going to work)



Lunch with colleagues



Meeting a group of friends



Spending time alone



Meeting specific friends



Physical movement



Once you have an idea of what charges your battery and what drains you, you can better organize your days and weeks to maximize your well-being.

Use the provided workbook template to draft your plan.



More energy
for what matters

Example recovery plan

Below is an example of a recovery plan that has been filled out to help you understand how to integrate activities that give you energy into your daily routine.

Example recovery plan



Morning

Start the day with positive energy

- 1 After waking up, do some light stretching and deep breathing, then set an intention for the day ahead.
- 2 Have a healthy breakfast while enjoying a calm atmosphere (no phone).
- 3 Set aside 30 minutes for a focused activity, such as reading or doing strategic work, before your main tasks.



Afternoon

Maintain energy in the middle of the day

- 1 Every 2 hours, take a short break to drink water, stand up, and stretch.
- 2 Have lunch with colleagues to strengthen social connections.
- 3 If you feel tired, take 5–10 minutes for a short walk or breathing exercise.



Evening

Maintain focus and a healthy transition

- 1 Finish your main work and create a to-do list for the next day.
- 2 Do light physical activity, such as a walk around the office or a short workout.
- 3 Spend time connecting with family, friends, or your partner.



Bedtime

Rest and recharge

- 1 Put your work devices away and keep your phone at least 1 hour before sleep (use a physical alarm clock).
- 2 Do a calming activity, such as reading a book, journaling, or light meditation.
- 3 Ensure consistent and sufficient sleep.



Key takeaway

This is just an example. You can adjust the activities, timing, and people involved based on your own needs and circumstances. Use the provided workbook template to create your own recovery plan.

Emotional flexibility and habit making

UNDERSTAND YOUR EMOTIONS.
MAKE BETTER CHOICES.



When it comes to learning and adapting, our mental well-being obviously plays a big role. What might be surprising is the **importance of “emotional flexibility,”** which is easy to overlook and often hard to do.



Emotions are powerful, and emotional flexibility helps us to harness that power in ways that support our well-being. The more we tune into our emotions, and recognize patterns, the better we are able to use them as **a compass to guide our choices and behaviors.**



For example, choosing to **address the emotion or to let it go** (a practice called defusion). Watch the video for some advice on how to do this.



Watch the video

for practical advice on how to build emotional flexibility.

